GLENN'S GREATEST HITS CONTENT BANK

POST 1: "Me at 20:

• Bought a mirrorless camera to "look legit"
• Shot everything on auto like it was a fancy iPhone
• Photos looked dead - no soul, no story

Me at 27:
• Surf between Manual, Aperture, and Shutter Priority like it's second nature
• Every setting choice has purpose
• I can make a parking lot look like a movie scene

A lot can change in 7 years. Focus.

No one cares what you shoot on. Only what you see"
Engagement: 292 30 11 40882
Performance Index: 0.29 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: Story-style comparison list

"Me at 20:
• Bought a mirrorless camera to "look legit"
• Shot everything on auto like it was a fancy iPhone
• Photos looked dead - no soul, no story

Me at 27:
• Surf between Manual, Aperture, and Shutter Priority like it's second nature
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A lot can change in 7 years. Focus.

No one cares what you shoot on. Only what you see"

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Strong contrast & personal growth, high relatability
- Emotional triggers: Transformation, competence, focus
- Key engagement drivers: Then-vs-now mirror, bullets, moral

POST 2: "7 things I wish I knew about photography 7 years ago:

- Buying a better camera doesn't make you better
- Shooting RAW is useless if you edit like a coward
- Gear doesn't fix bad framing. Composition does.
- People remember how your photo felt, not how it looked
- "Fix it in post" is code for "I shot it wrong"

- You don’t need full manual - just full understanding
- Trends rot your creative voice

Do these 7 things to grow a style, not just a feed.”
Engagement: 72 👍 37 💬 4 🔁 3053 👁
Performance Index: 1.34 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: Listicle

“7 things I wish I knew about photography 7 years ago:

- Buying a better camera doesn’t make you better
- Shooting RAW is useless if you edit like a coward
- Gear doesn’t fix bad framing. Composition does.
- People remember how your photo felt, not how it looked
- “Fix it in post” is code for “I shot it wrong”
- You don’t need full manual - just full understanding
- Trends rot your creative voice

Do these 7 things to grow a style, not just a feed.”

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Clear numeric promise, curiosity via '7 things', medium-high
- Emotional triggers: Regret, improvement, authenticity
- Key engagement drivers: Numbered list, contrarian truths

POST 3: “18 months of growing as a creator taught me what really works 👇

• Use gridlines. Every damn time.
• Shoot at eye level — not ego level.
• Tap to focus. Adjust. Tap again. Light matters.
• Edit like a psychopath. Lightroom>Instagram filters
• Post the story behind the shot. Not just the shot.
• You’re not an influencer. You’re a storyteller.
• Use motion. Even a finger blur = dopamine
• Steal angles from movie posters, not influencers

Use these to grab attention faster than a Netflix thriller.”
Engagement: 34 👍 11 💬 7 🔁 2999 👁
Performance Index: 0.63 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: Listicle/Tips

“18 months of growing as a creator taught me what really works 👇

• Use gridlines. Every damn time.
• Shoot at eye level — not ego level.
• Tap to focus. Adjust. Tap again. Light matters.
• Edit like a psychopath. Lightroom>Instagram filters
• Post the story behind the shot. Not just the shot.
• You’re not an influencer. You’re a storyteller.
• Use motion. Even a finger blur = dopamine
• Steal angles from movie posters, not influencers

Use these to grab attention faster than a Netflix thriller.”

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Bold claim and ' 👇 ' pointer, encourages reading, medium
- Emotional triggers: Authority, actionable tips, urgency
- Key engagement drivers: Rapid-fire tips, pop culture ref

POST 4: “You don’t take better photos by upgrading your camera.

You take better photos by upgrading your eye.”
Engagement: 19 👍 9 💬 5 🔁 2734 👁
Performance Index: 0.44 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: One-liner

“You don’t take better photos by upgrading your camera.
You take better photos by upgrading your eye.”

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Punchy aphorism, concise, medium
- Emotional triggers: Self-improvement, simplicity
- Key engagement drivers: Memorable quote

POST 5: “What’s something you wish you knew when you first picked up a camera?

I’ll go first, no editing is 100x better than over editing

Photography Threads”
Engagement: 11 👍 46 💬 0 🔁 1583 👁
Performance Index: 1.3 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: Question prompt

“What’s something you wish you knew when you first picked up a camera?

I’ll go first, no editing is 100x better than over editing

Photography Threads”

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Question engages community, high comments, medium-high
- Emotional triggers: Community sharing, nostalgia
- Key engagement drivers: Call for participation, responds to others

POST 6: “SERIOUSLY!

STOP shooting 100+ photos hoping one turns out good and START fucking composing with intention.
That is all.”
Engagement: 15 👍 22 💬 2 🔁 852 👁
Performance Index: 1.65 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: Short rant

“SERIOUSLY!
STOP shooting 100+ photos hoping one turns out good and START fucking composing with intention.
That is all.”

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: All-caps imperative, urgency, strong
- Emotional triggers: Frustration, tough love
- Key engagement drivers: Shock value, minimal text

POST 7: “You can never say the gear you have isn’t good enough

This is Garrett King (aka @shortstache)

No DSLR. No agency. No backup plan.

Just an iPhone… and taste.

But what happened next flipped the entire industry on its head.”
Engagement: 7 👍 13 💬 6 🔁 846 👁
Performance Index: 1.11 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: Mini-story teaser

“You can never say the gear you have isn’t good enough

This is Garrett King (aka @shortstache)

No DSLR. No agency. No backup plan.

Just an iPhone… and taste.

But what happened next flipped the entire industry on its head.”

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Narrative intrigue about influencer, medium
- Emotional triggers: Inspiration, underdog story
- Key engagement drivers: Name-drop success story, suspense

POST 8: “□

I’m 27.

I wasted 3 years chasing every “perfect settings” tutorial on YouTube and still felt lost.

Today I shoot with confidence, edit with purpose, and help others find their own visual voice.

Here are 5 lessons about photography style I wish I knew 7 years ago (steal these to skip my mistakes)”
Engagement: 4 👍 11 💬 3 🔁 463 👁
Performance Index: 1.41 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: Long-form (Teacher thread)

“□

I’m 27.

I wasted 3 years chasing every “perfect settings” tutorial on YouTube and still felt lost.

Today I shoot with confidence, edit with purpose, and help others find their own visual voice.

Here are 5 lessons about photography style I wish I knew 7 years ago (steal these to skip my mistakes)”

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Thread icon & personal confession sets up credibility, medium-high
- Emotional triggers: Vulnerability, mentorship, hope
- Key engagement drivers: Thread format, CTA to steal lessons

POST 9: “I’m 27.

If you’re trying to “make it” as a photographer, do these 7 things:

• Shoot every day ~ even when it sucks
• Post your flops ~ not just your favorites
• Build your eye, not just your feed
• Study photographers, not influencers
• Stop hiding behind your gear
• Say something with every frame
• Burn your need for validation

Photography isn’t about looking good.
It’s about feeling seen.

Show us something real.
That's what sticks."
Engagement: 5 4 1 395
Performance Index: 0.92 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: Listicle/Manifesto

"I'm 27.

If you're trying to "make it" as a photographer, do these 7 things:

• Shoot every day ~ even when it sucks
• Post your flops ~ not just your favorites
• Build your eye, not just your feed
• Study photographers, not influencers
• Stop hiding behind your gear
• Say something with every frame
• Burn your need for validation

Photography isn't about looking good.
It's about feeling seen.

Show us something real.
That's what sticks."

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Relatable for aspiring photographers, numbered list, medium
- Emotional triggers: Encouragement, realism
- Key engagement drivers: Actionable list, relatability

POST 10: "REAL TALK:

If you don't know why you pressed the shutter, the viewer won't care."
Engagement: 5 4 1 395
Performance Index: 0.92 (relative to avg view-based rate)
Format: One-liner truth bomb

"REAL TALK:
If you don't know why you pressed the shutter, the viewer won't care."

Analysis Notes:

- Hook effectiveness: Caps 'REAL TALK' adds authority, medium
- Emotional triggers: Accountability, clarity
- Key engagement drivers: Blunt truth, shareable quote

PERFORMANCE SUMMARY

Top 3 Highest-Performing Posts: #6, #8, #2
Average Engagement Benchmark: 2.77% (view-based)
Dominant Content Themes: Transformation & growth, Gear vs skill, Authentic storytelling, Intentional composition, Community advice
Most Effective Hook Patterns: Contrast-led personal stories, Numeric listicles, Caps/imperative truth bombs, Rhetorical questions
Voice Consistency Elements: Direct & punchy lines, casual profanity, rhetorical devices, photography metaphors, tough-love coaching tone

Voice Integration:

- Your audience resonate with honest underdog stories that show the build rather than just the skyline.
- Leverage foundation metaphors (shooting fundamentals as concrete footings) to explain growth systems.
- Strategic vulnerability (owning past mistakes) reliably boosts comments and saves.
- Posts that channel the short hype sentences, emoji spark—see higher repost velocity.

A Cheap Film Camera will make you a Better Photographer

It's not as crazy as it sounds

I'm sure we've all felt it, that urge to take just one more photo… or ten.
It's so easy now. Autofocus is faster, cameras shoot endless frames per second, and SD cards are bottomless pits. The temptation to capture everything and sort it out later is real.
At first, it doesn't seem like a problem. Composition a little off? No big deal, I'll crop in post. Exposure not quite right? I shot in RAW, I'll fix it later. Don't know exactly what I'm going for? I'll take a bunch of versions and figure it out. But over time, that habit creeps in. We rely more on the tools and less on the craft. Creativity fades. We get lazy.
I noticed it in my own work and knew I needed a reset. Then, I got a gift: a Kodak EKTAR H35. No fancy lens, no settings, no second chances. Just point, frame, and click. No preview screen, no perfecting things later.

And something shifted. Every time I used that camera, I slowed down. I thought more. I composed with care. And when I picked up my mirrorless again, that mindset came with me. Every shot felt more intentional, more considered. Edits became minimal, just color and style tweaks.

So here’s the takeaway: slowing down matters. Whether it’s a film camera or a film-style app, build something into your workflow that forces you to shoot with purpose. The results speak for themselves.
If you want to delve deeper into the thought process behind photography and the reason certain choices are made for exposure, framing, composition and more I go into more detail in The Art of Seeing, The Beginner Photographer’s guide